

LaszloSaldo

User guide

Family finances, step by step

Windows 10 / 11, 64-bit · Version 0.18.0

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This guide describes the released app. Screenshots contain demo data; some older labels may differ from your installed version. The licence term is 2 years even if an older screen uses the word “annual”.

Contents and page numbers

01 Get started in 5 minutes	2
02 Install and launch	3
03 Trial and activation	4
04 Income and expenses	5
05 Budgets and overspending	6
06 Goals and savings	7
07 Debts and repayments	8
08 Book subscription payments	9
09 Overview, reports and search	10
10 Family spending	11
11 Attach documents	12
12 Events and deadlines	13
13 Settings, backup and restore	14
14 Troubleshooting and support	15

Downloads and information

<https://lnkr.es/LaszloSaldo/>

Support: mesterweb@lnkr.es

01 Get started in 5 minutes

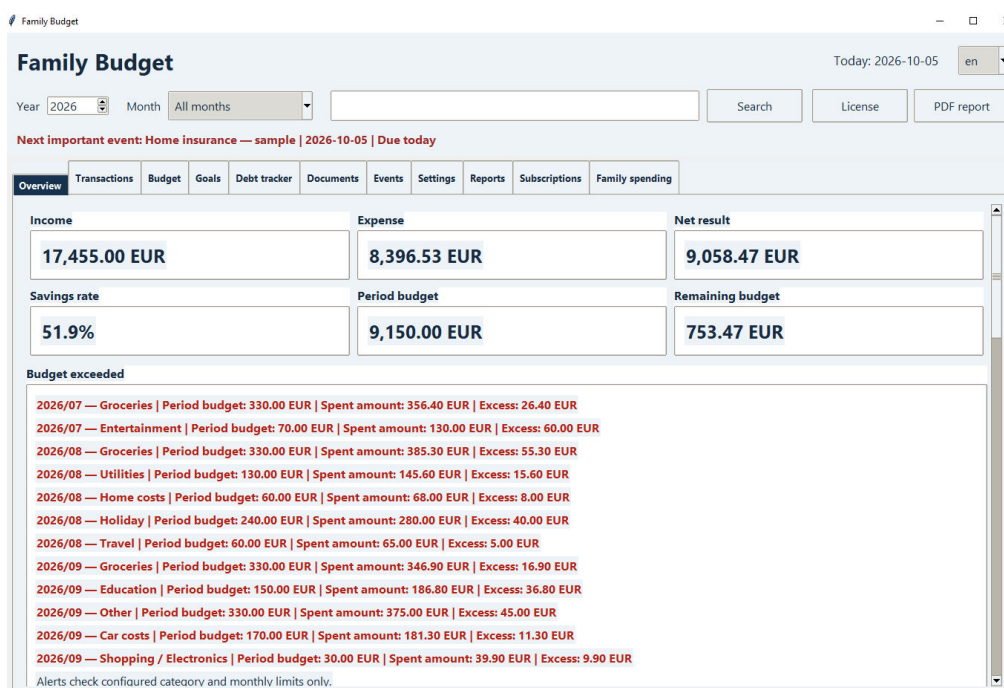
1. Open the app and choose en in the language selector at the top right. Set the year and month using the filters above the main tabs.
2. In Settings, select your currency and enter family members separated by commas: Anna, Peter. Save settings.
3. Open Transactions and click New to record income, then an expense. Choose the date, type, category and family member, and enter the amount.
4. Check the Overview cards and the totals at the bottom of Transactions. In Settings, choose a backup folder and create a backup.

Important

Enter amounts as numbers without a currency symbol. Use 45.80 as a reliable decimal format. For common household costs, choose Shared / Family.

Example

In one month, income of 2000 and a grocery expense of 45.80 give: income 2000, expenses 45.80, net result 1954.20.



Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

02 Install and launch

1. Download LaszloSaldo-Setup-0.18.0.exe from the official website. Run it, choose the installer language, and follow the steps.
2. Launch the installed app from its desktop or Start menu shortcut. The Windows package does not require a separate installation of Python, Excel or ReportLab.
3. For the portable version, extract the entire ZIP. Run LaszloSaldo.exe inside the extracted folder and keep every supplied file together.
4. Before updating, create a backup and close the app. Install the new version. Uninstalling removes the program; financial data and licence state stored separately are retained.

Important

Edge or Windows may warn about the new unsigned installer. Verify the official source and checksum; do not disable Windows protection.

Example

Copying only the EXE out of the ZIP is insufficient. The portable package also needs its _internal folder.

03 Trial and activation

1. A 30-day free trial starts on first use. No licence code is required in advance. The License button is near the top of the main window.
2. In the License window, click Copy device ID. Email the app's own 64-character ID to mesterweb@lnkr.es. The Windows device ID is not the correct identifier.
3. The licence costs €17 + VAT for 2 years on one computer. After payment arrangements and receipt of payment, you receive a .license file by email.
4. Save the file, choose Activate license file in the License window, and open the supplied file. Check the active status and expiry date. Restart the app to confirm.

Important

After the trial or licence expires, existing data can still be viewed, backed up and exported; editing requires an active licence. Do not move the computer date forward for testing: changing it back can trigger the clock check.

Example

A two-year licence issued with a start date of 2026-10-07 expires on 2028-10-07. Another computer has a different device ID; contact support before changing computers.

04 Income and expenses

1. Transactions → New: select the date with the calendar button or enter YYYY-MM-DD. Set Type to Income or Expense.
2. Choose from the category list for that type: Salary or Pension for income; Groceries, Utilities or Phone for expenses. Enter the family member, amount, shop/supplier and an optional note.
3. Click Save or press Enter. For a Possible duplicate warning, OK saves anyway; Cancel returns to the completed form so you can correct it.
4. To change a record, select the row and click Edit. To remove it, use Delete and confirm. The list and its totals follow the selected year and month.

Important

Enter an expense as a positive amount: the Expense type determines its direction. A duplicate warning indicates a possible match, not proof of an error.

Example

2026-10-08 · Expense · Groceries · Anna · 45.80 · Aldi · Weekly groceries.

The screenshot shows the 'Family Budget' application interface. At the top, there's a header with the title 'Family Budget' and a date selector set to 'Today: 2026-10-05'. Below this is a navigation bar with tabs for 'Overview', 'Transactions', 'Budget', 'Goals', 'Debt tracker', 'Documents', 'Events', 'Settings', 'Reports', 'Subscriptions', and 'Family spending'. The 'Transactions' tab is active. Below the navigation bar, there are buttons for 'New', 'Edit', and 'Delete', along with 'CSV export' and 'PDF report'. The main area displays a table of transactions for the year 2026. The table has columns for Date, Type, Category, Family member, Amount, Shop / supplier, and Note. The transactions listed are for July 2026. At the bottom, there's a summary for '2026 / All months' showing Income: 17,455.00 EUR, Expense: 8,396.53 EUR, and Balance: 9,058.47 EUR.

Date	Type	Category	Family member	Amount	Shop / supplier	Note
2026-07-01	Income	Salary	Emma	2,100.00 EUR	Blue Coast Company (...)	Emma's monthly salary
2026-07-02	Income	Salary	James	1,900.00 EUR	Family Workshop (ficti...	James's monthly salary
2026-07-02	Expense	Housing	Shared / Family	850.00 EUR	Landlord (fictional)	Family home rent
2026-07-03	Income	Pension	Margaret	950.00 EUR	Pension Provider (ficti...	Margaret's monthly pension
2026-07-03	Expense	Groceries	Emma	82.45 EUR	Mercadona	Weekly groceries: fruit, vegetables, meat ...
2026-07-04	Expense	Transport	Emma	38.00 EUR	Local Bus Operator (fi...	Monthly bus pass
2026-07-05	Income	Benefits / allowance	Emma	120.00 EUR	Family Allowance Pro...	Example family allowance
2026-07-05	Expense	Car costs	James	58.70 EUR	Repsol	Fuel for the family car
2026-07-06	Expense	Utilities	Shared / Family	68.30 EUR	Iberdrola	Electricity bill
2026-07-07	Expense	Utilities	Shared / Family	32.80 EUR	Water Supplier (fictio...	Water bill
2026-07-08	Expense	Utilities	Shared / Family	24.90 EUR	Gas Supplier (fictional)	Gas bill
2026-07-08	Expense	Phone	James	12.00 EUR	Demo Mobile Provider	Mobile phone bill

2026 / All months

Income: 17,455.00 EUR	Expense: 8,396.53 EUR	Balance: 9,058.47 EUR
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Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

05 Budgets and overspending

1. In Budget, create a monthly limit with a year, month, expense category and amount, then save it.
2. The app compares the limit with expenses recorded in that category for that month. Use spent amounts, remaining budget and overspending notices to follow progress.
3. Change the year/month filters to review another period. In All months view, still check each individual monthly limit.
4. If the limit or category is wrong, select and edit the row. Add missing custom categories in Settings first.

Important

Alerts cover configured monthly category limits only. Categories are checked separately; do not assume a subcategory is automatically combined with its parent category's budget.

Example

A grocery limit of 300 and expenses of 325 produce an excess of 25. A category without a configured limit does not generate an overspending alert.

The screenshot shows the 'Family Budget' app interface. At the top, there's a header with the app name and a date selector set to 'Today: 2026-10-05'. Below this, there are filters for 'Year' (2026) and 'Month' (All months), along with 'Search', 'License', and 'PDF report' buttons. A notification bar indicates a 'Next important event: Home insurance — sample | 2026-10-05 | Due today'. The main navigation bar includes tabs for Overview, Transactions, Budget (selected), Goals, Debt tracker, Documents, Events, Settings, Reports, Subscriptions, and Family spending. Under the 'Budget' tab, there are 'New', 'Edit', and 'Delete' buttons. A table lists monthly limits for 2026, month 7, for various categories: Housing (850.00 EUR), Groceries (330.00 EUR), Utilities (130.00 EUR), Transport (70.00 EUR), Insurance (60.00 EUR), Education (150.00 EUR), and Dining out (90.00 EUR). Below the table, a 'Budget exceeded' section lists several instances where the budget was exceeded, including Groceries, Entertainment, Utilities, Home costs, and Holiday, with details on period budget, spent amount, and excess.

Year	Month	Category	Monthly limit
2026	7	Housing	850.00 EUR
2026	7	Groceries	330.00 EUR
2026	7	Utilities	130.00 EUR
2026	7	Transport	70.00 EUR
2026	7	Insurance	60.00 EUR
2026	7	Education	150.00 EUR
2026	7	Dining out	90.00 EUR

Budget exceeded

- 2026/07 — Groceries | Period budget: 330.00 EUR | Spent amount: 356.40 EUR | Excess: 26.40 EUR
- 2026/07 — Entertainment | Period budget: 70.00 EUR | Spent amount: 130.00 EUR | Excess: 60.00 EUR
- 2026/08 — Groceries | Period budget: 330.00 EUR | Spent amount: 385.30 EUR | Excess: 55.30 EUR
- 2026/08 — Utilities | Period budget: 130.00 EUR | Spent amount: 145.60 EUR | Excess: 15.60 EUR
- 2026/08 — Home costs | Period budget: 60.00 EUR | Spent amount: 68.00 EUR | Excess: 8.00 EUR
- 2026/08 — Holiday | Period budget: 240.00 EUR | Spent amount: 280.00 EUR | Excess: 40.00 EUR
- 2026/08 — Total | Period budget: 60.00 EUR | Spent amount: 68.00 EUR | Excess: 8.00 EUR

Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

06 Goals and savings

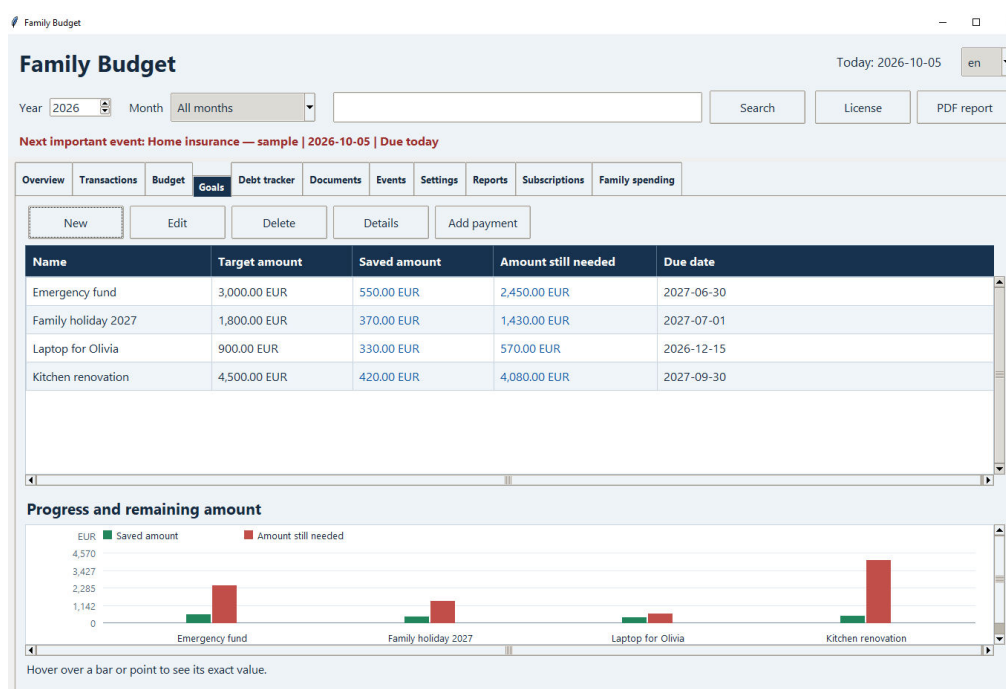
1. In Goals, click New and enter the name, target amount, already saved amount and due date. The initial saved amount can be zero.
2. To add savings, click an amount, open Details, or double-click the row. Enter only the new amount, with its date and note.
3. After saving, the total saved amount increases. Details show the history, amount still needed and completion percentage.
4. The chart below the goals compares saved and remaining amounts. Click it to open a larger chart window.

Important

Adding money to a goal does not create an income or expense transaction. An amount entered when creating the goal may appear as a previous amount without a date in the history.

Example

Holiday target: 1200; saved: 200. Add 100 → saved: 300; still needed: 900. Do not enter the entire 300 as a new payment.



Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

07 Debts and repayments

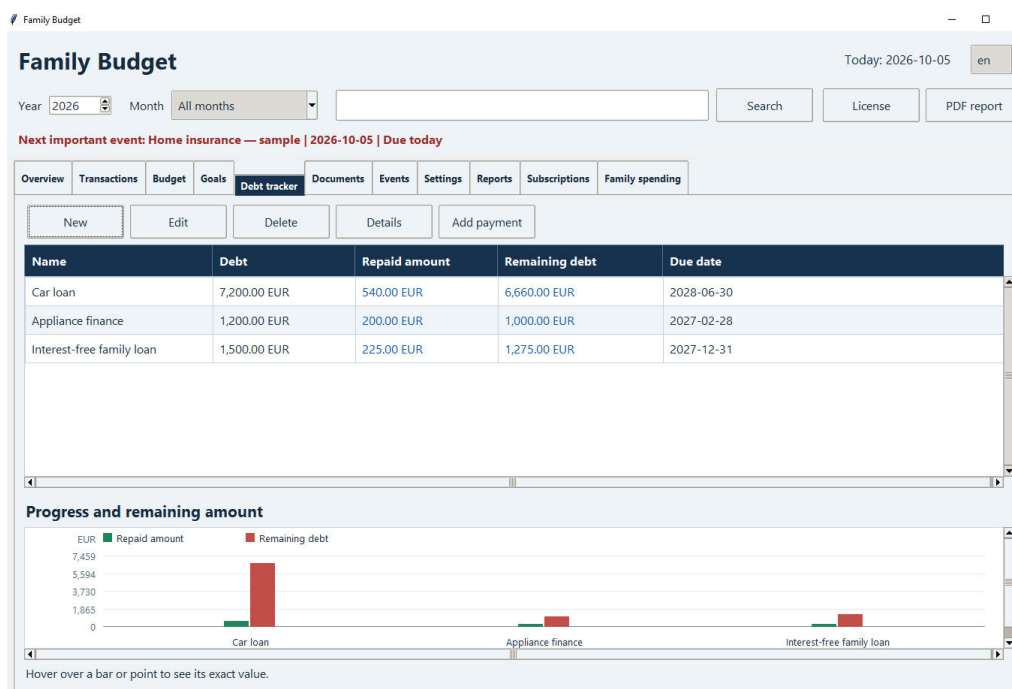
1. In Debt tracker, enter the debt name, total debt, amount already repaid and due date. Remaining debt appears in its own column.
2. Open the row's Details to add a repayment. Enter the payment date, new amount, note and Payer. Use Shared / Family for a common household payment.
3. If the expense already exists in Transactions, choose it from the suggested matches and link it. Check amount, payer, date, category and note before approving.
4. If no expense exists yet, choose New expense and repayment. This also creates an expense transaction. Check repayment history and the repaid/remaining chart.

Important

Linking creates no new expense. Suggested matches have the same amount and payer, with dates at most 7 days apart; do not select an equal payment for another debt. A repayment cannot exceed the remaining debt.

Example

Debt 1000, already repaid 200. A new repayment of 100 gives repaid 300 and remaining 700. If that 100 expense exists, link it rather than recording it again.



Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

08 Book subscription payments

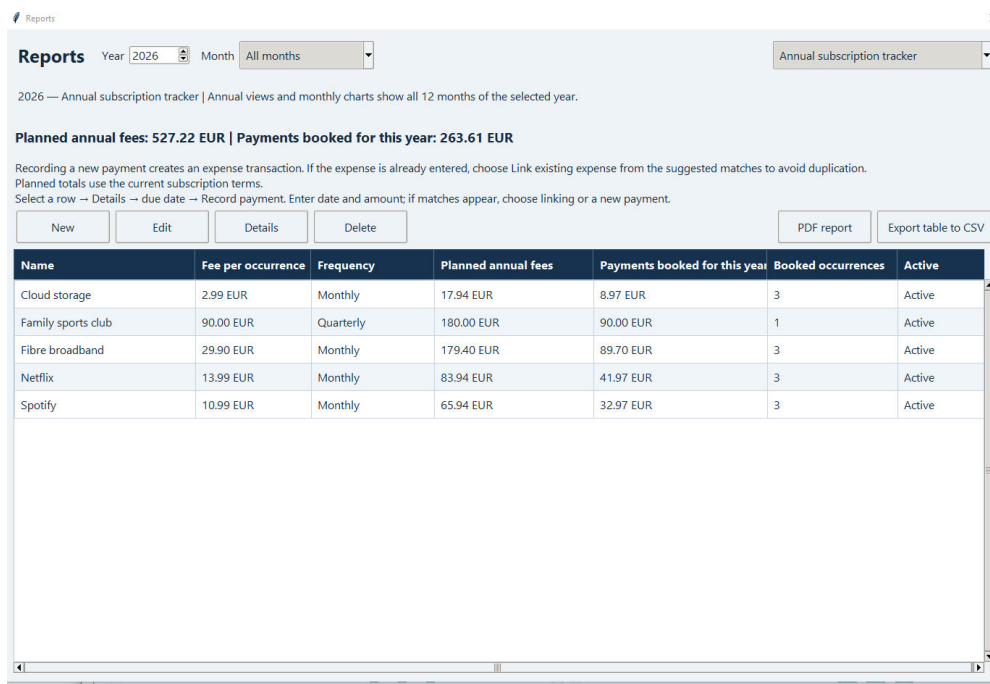
1. Open Subscriptions from the main tabs or the subscription tracker in Reports. For a new subscription, enter its name, fee per occurrence, category, family member, supplier and first due date.
2. Choose Monthly, Quarterly or Yearly. Set an optional last date and the Active checkbox as needed.
3. Select the subscription → Details → choose a due occurrence → Book payment. Enter the actual payment date and amount.
4. If the expense is already recorded, select Link existing expense. Otherwise record a new payment, which also creates an expense transaction. Check the booked annual amount and occurrences.

Important

Planned annual fees are not booked payments. Booked totals can stay at zero until you record or link payments. Suggested matches require approval; existing transactions are not linked automatically.

Example

A monthly fee of 12 with 12 due occurrences gives a planned annual total of 144. After booking one payment of 12, the booked amount is 12. Deleting a subscription retains its expense transactions.



Reports Year: 2026 Month: All months Annual subscription tracker

2026 — Annual subscription tracker | Annual views and monthly charts show all 12 months of the selected year.

Planned annual fees: 527.22 EUR | Payments booked for this year: 263.61 EUR

Recording a new payment creates an expense transaction. If the expense is already entered, choose Link existing expense from the suggested matches to avoid duplication.
Planned totals use the current subscription terms.
Select a row → Details → due date → Record payment. Enter date and amount; if matches appear, choose linking or a new payment.

Name	Fee per occurrence	Frequency	Planned annual fees	Payments booked for this year	Booked occurrences	Active
Cloud storage	2.99 EUR	Monthly	17.94 EUR	8.97 EUR	3	Active
Family sports club	90.00 EUR	Quarterly	180.00 EUR	90.00 EUR	1	Active
Fibre broadband	29.90 EUR	Monthly	179.40 EUR	89.70 EUR	3	Active
Netflix	13.99 EUR	Monthly	83.94 EUR	41.97 EUR	3	Active
Spotify	10.99 EUR	Monthly	65.94 EUR	32.97 EUR	3	Active

Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

09 Overview, reports and search

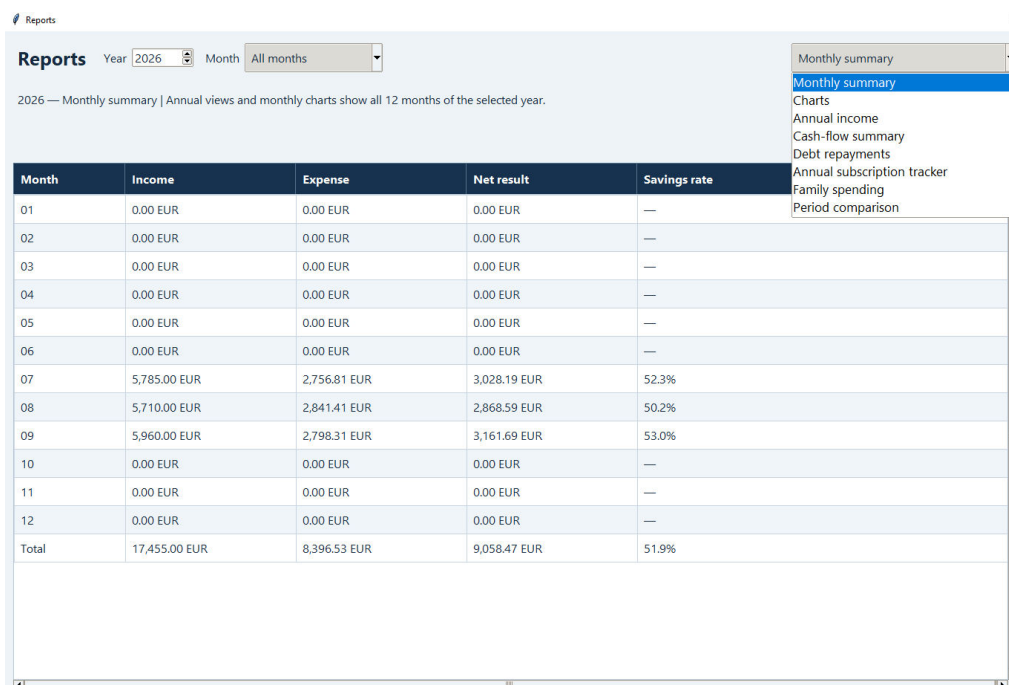
1. Overview cards and charts show income, expenses, balance and expense distribution. Check the year/month selection first.
2. In Reports, choose Monthly summary, Annual income, Cash-flow summary, Debt repayments, Period comparison or Charts. Annual charts show all 12 months of the selected year.
3. Click a chart to open it in a larger window. Use horizontal and vertical scrollbars when needed. Hover over a bar or point to inspect its exact value.
4. Use PDF report to save the selected view. Search from the main window by name, note or another searchable value; press Enter or click Search.

Important

Search covers all years independently of the filters and displays up to 200 matches. Document search uses names and metadata, not the attached file's text. The cash-flow running balance is not a bank-account balance.

Example

Net result = income - expenses. Savings rate = net result / income × 100 when income exists. A comparison percentage is undefined when the previous value is zero.



Reports Year: 2026 Month: All months

2026 — Monthly summary | Annual views and monthly charts show all 12 months of the selected year.

Month	Income	Expense	Net result	Savings rate
01	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
02	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
03	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
04	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
05	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
06	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
07	5,785.00 EUR	2,756.81 EUR	3,028.19 EUR	52.3%
08	5,710.00 EUR	2,841.41 EUR	2,868.59 EUR	50.2%
09	5,960.00 EUR	2,798.31 EUR	3,161.69 EUR	53.0%
10	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
11	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
12	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	0.00 EUR	—
Total	17,455.00 EUR	8,396.53 EUR	9,058.47 EUR	51.9%

Dropdown menu options: Monthly summary, Monthly summary, Charts, Annual income, Cash-flow summary, Debt repayments, Annual subscription tracker, Family spending, Period comparison.

Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

10 Family spending

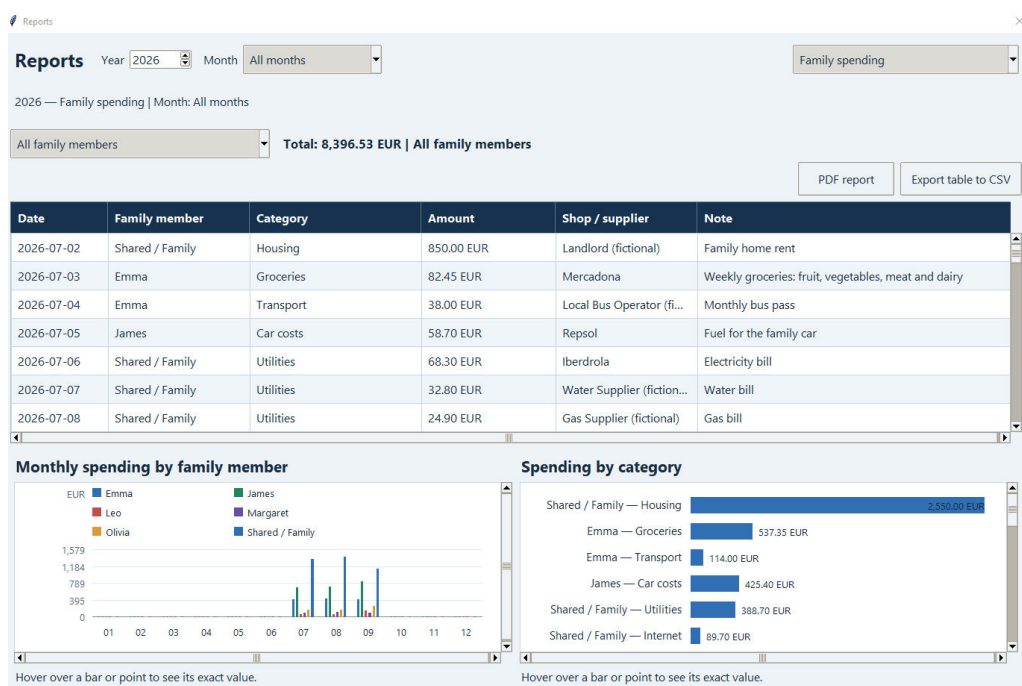
1. Open Family spending from the main tabs or Reports. Choose the year, month and a family member, or All family members.
2. The list shows expenses matching that selection. Review date, category, family member and amount, as in Transactions.
3. Below the list, review monthly spending by family member and spending by category. Click a chart to enlarge it.
4. If an expense belongs to the wrong person, edit its transaction and reopen the report.

Important

This is an expense analysis: income is excluded. Shared / Family expenses are separate; the app does not automatically divide them among family members.

Example

Anna spends 50 on groceries and 30 on clothing: total 80. A shared utility expense of 100 does not automatically increase Anna's personal total of 80.



Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

11 Attach documents

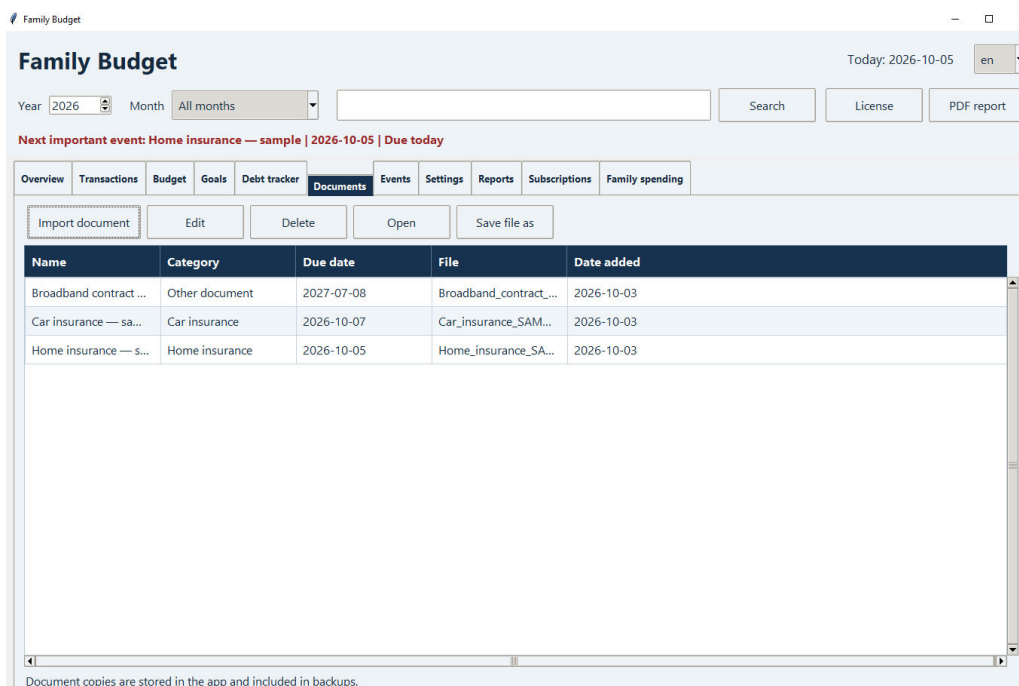
1. Documents → Import document: enter a document name. Choose its type or type a custom one, such as Warranty or Rental agreement.
2. Choose file to select the document. Optionally set a due date with the calendar. After saving, a custom document type is also available in the list.
3. Select the saved row and click Open. Windows uses the application associated with that file type.
4. Use Save file as to create a separate copy. Edit can change the name, type, due date and, if needed, replace the attachment.

Important

Supported formats: PDF, JPG/JPEG, PNG, DOC/DOCX, XLS/XLSX and TXT, up to 20 MB per file. The app stores a copy included in DB backups. Opening a document requires a suitable Windows application.

Example

Name: Home insurance 2027. Type: Home insurance. File: policy.pdf. Due date: 2027-02-01.



Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

12 Events and deadlines

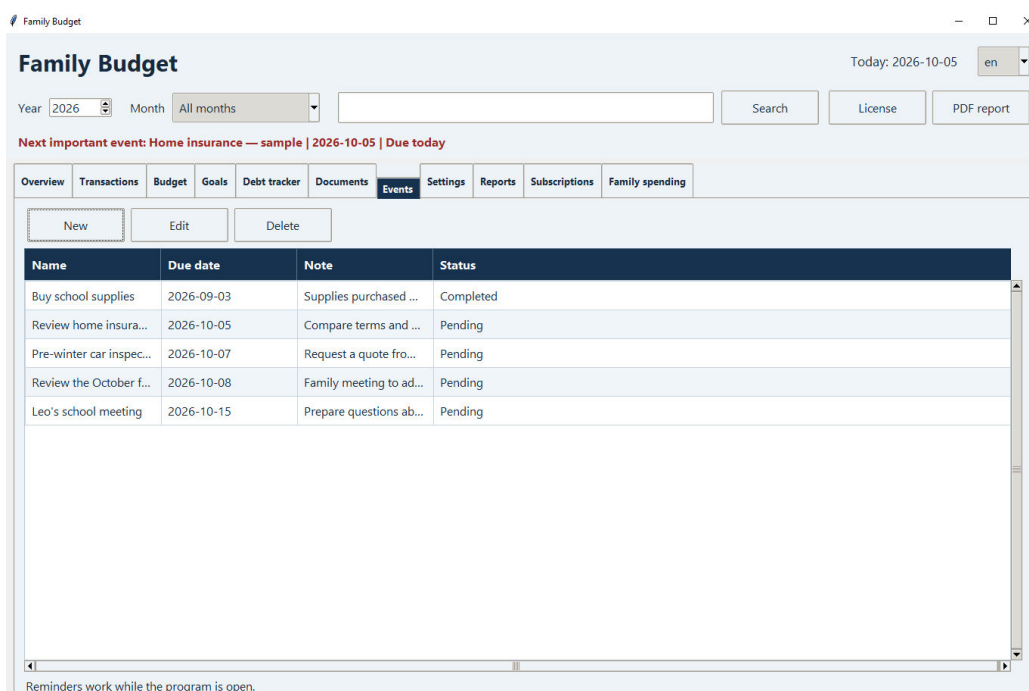
1. In Events, click New and enter the name, due date and note. Mark an event Completed when it has been handled.
2. The main window displays today's date and the next important deadline. Review upcoming and overdue items regularly.
3. Click the Overview card for events in the next 7 days to open the detailed list. It can include events and deadlines from documents, goals and debts.
4. Open the relevant item from the detailed list and update its date or status when needed.

Important

Reminders operate while the app is open. With LaszloSaldo closed, there is no guaranteed Windows notification or email. Review your dates rather than relying solely on the weekly card.

Example

Add an insurance renewal due next week. Check that it appears in the weekly list and mark the event Completed after dealing with it.



Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

13 Settings, backup and restore

1. In Settings, Currency changes display only; it does not convert recorded amounts. Enter family member names separated by commas and save.
2. Manage shops / suppliers lets you add new names. In Categories and subcategories, choose income or expense, a name and an optional parent. Custom names retain their spelling when you change language.
3. In Backup and restore, choose a backup folder and click Create backup. The app creates a dated family-backup-... .db file and shows its location.
4. Before restoring, make a new backup of your current data. Click Restore, select the earlier DB file and confirm. Then verify transactions and documents.

Important

Restore overwrites current data; it does not merge databases. Keep another copy on an external drive, since a computer failure can affect local backups too. A financial backup does not transfer the computer-bound licence.

Example

Backup → delete four test transactions → restore → the four records reappear. Always keep a separate current backup before restoring real data.

The screenshot shows the 'Family Budget' application interface. At the top, there's a header with the app name and a date/language selector showing 'Today: 2026-10-05' and 'en'. Below this is a navigation bar with tabs: Overview, Transactions, Budget, Goals, Debt tracker, Documents, Events, Settings (selected), Reports, Subscriptions, and Family spending. The main content area is titled 'Backup and restore' and contains several sections. The first section has a 'Choose backup folder' input field and a 'Create backup' button. Below this, it says 'No backup folder selected yet.' and has a 'Restore' button. The second section is for 'Currency', with a dropdown menu set to 'EUR'. The third section is for 'Family members (comma separated)', with a text input field containing 'Emma,James,Olivia,Leo,Margaret' and a 'Save settings' button. Below this, a note states 'Currency changes the display only; it does not convert amounts.' The fourth section has two buttons: 'Manage shops / suppliers' and 'Categories and subcategories'. The fifth section has two buttons: 'PDF report' and 'CSV export'. At the bottom, a small note says 'The PDF includes the selected year / month summary and transactions.'

Demo screen. Your data and selected period may differ.

14 Troubleshooting and support

1. Empty device ID: use the corrected 0.18.0 installer. Copy device ID in the License window gives 64 characters. Do not send the Windows system identifier.
2. Zero booked subscription amount: planning is not payment. Open Details and book or link the expense to its due occurrence.
3. Missing transaction: check year, month and family member. All months covers the selected year; global Search covers every year.
4. Attachment will not open: check whether Windows has a suitable associated application. For PDF export problems, update the Windows installer; the release includes the PDF dependencies.
5. For support, send the app version, Windows version, steps and exact error message or screenshot. Hide personal financial details; send a full database only by separate agreement.

Important

For a clock-check warning, correct the system date and contact support. Do not delete licence state or try to restart the trial by changing dates.

Example

Custom changes start at €10 + VAT per request, depending on the work, with an advance quote. Contact: mesterweb@lnkr.es. Website: <https://lnkr.es/LaszloSaldo/>